01 AVIATION INFRASTRUCTURE

Private airports

A briefing on the assets, operations, and obligations behind private airport investment.

THE INVESTMENT LENS

Private airports are specialized infrastructure assets. Their operating profile can depend on the airport's permitted use, location, facilities, access, surrounding activity, and the requirements of its users. Potential involvement may take different forms, including ownership, development, or participation alongside an experienced operator.

Considerations

- Understand the asset and operating structure: land, runway, terminal, hangars, fuel, services, and any third-party agreements.
- Assess permitted aircraft, operating hours, access arrangements, local demand, and reliance on particular users or tenants.
- Map the capital required for maintenance, resurfacing, safety systems, compliance, and future infrastructure upgrades.
- Review realistic operating, staffing, insurance, and environmental-management obligations over the life of the asset.

Risks to understand

- Aviation safety, licensing, regulatory changes, and restrictions on operating hours or aircraft.
- High fixed and capital costs; utilization, revenues, and property values may not meet expectations.
- Environmental liabilities, noise concerns, fuel handling, weather exposure, and community opposition.
- Concentration in a small number of tenants, customers, operators, or transport uses can affect liquidity and resilience.

BEFORE CONSIDERING AN OPPORTUNITY

Start with the questions that matter.

01 Who holds title to the airport land and infrastructure, and what easements, leases, liens, or access rights apply?

02 Which licences, safety approvals, permits, inspections, and operating restrictions apply in each jurisdiction?

03 What condition are the runway, buildings, utilities, fuel systems, and safety facilities in, and what verified capital plan supports them?

04 What independent demand, environmental, insurance, operator, and valuation reviews support the proposed business case?

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